Audio Plugin *Market:* *Global and* Growing

$2.3 *billions*

ESTIMATED SIZE OF

The global audio plugin software market in 2026

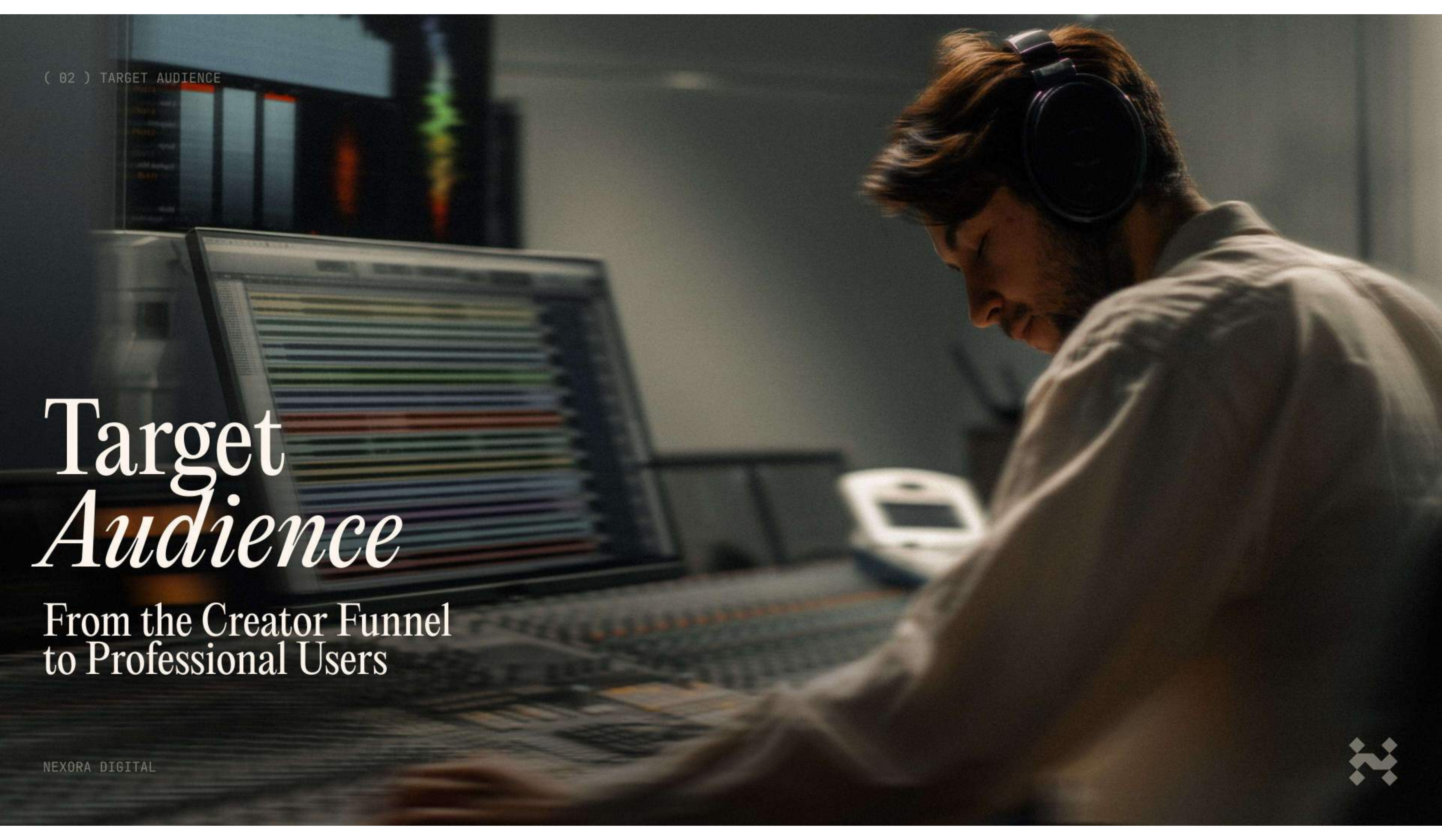
Projected market size, growing at an average annual rate of approximately 9.6%

$3.32 *billions by 2030*

*
This is a third-party market estimate and should be treated as an indication of total addressable market rather than an audited absolute figure

What this means:

AUDIO PLUGINS ARE NO LONGER A NICHE PRODUCT CATEGORY FOR A SMALL NUMBER OF STUDIOS. THEY ARE A GLOBAL SOFTWARE MARKET SERVING PRODUCERS, ARTISTS, AUDIO ENGINEERS, COMPOSERS, POST-PRODUCTION TEAMS, GAME DEVELOPERS, AND THE WIDER CREATOR ECONOMY. (RESEARCHANDMARKETS.COM)



Target *Audience*

From the Creator Funnel to Professional Users

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100 000 000 + *registered* users

BandLab alone had surpassed 100 million registered music creators by 2024.

(MUSICBUSINESSWORLDWIDE.COM)

Up to 1B *creators* by 2032

MIDiA Research forecasts this scale for the wider creator economy.

THIS DOES NOT MEAN ONE BILLION VST CUSTOMERS, BUT IT DEMONSTRATES THE SIZE AND CONTINUED EXPANSION OF THE TOP OF THE FUNNEL. (MIDIARESEARCH.COM)

Our *paying* audiences

Independent producers and artists

LOOKING FOR FAST, DISTINCTIVE SOUND, INSPIRING PRESETS, AND IMMEDIATE CREATIVE RESULTS

Mixing and mastering engineers, studios, film and game composers

PAYING FOR SOUND QUALITY, RELIABILITY, AND TIME SAVINGS

Vocalists and content creators

NEEDING INTUITIVE TOOLS FOR VOCAL PROCESSING, SOUND DESIGN, AND POLISHED OUTPUT

KEY TAKEAWAY:

We do not need to sell to “all musicians.” Each plugin should begin with one highly specific problem and one clearly defined user.

Revenue and *Profit* Potential of a *Successful* Plugin

SCENARIO	MONTHLY SALES	AVERAGE PRICE	ANNUAL REVENUE	OPERATING PROFIT*
Early traction	125	$69	$103.5K	~$43K
Product–market fit	500	$79	$474K	~$229K
International scale	1,500	$99	$1.78M	~$837K

*
Operating profit before corporate income tax

Model *logic:*

15–25% of revenue is allocated to variable costs:

PAYMENT PROCESSING, REFUND RESERVE, AFFILIATE AND CREATOR COMMISSIONS, AND STOREFRONT FEES

Remaining operating costs:

DEVELOPMENT, DESIGN, SUPPORT, CONTENT, UPDATES, AND MARKETING

The figures assume a stable year of sales

NOT A SINGLE LAUNCH SPIKE

Key takeaway:

EVEN ONE STRONG PLUGIN GENERATING SEVERAL HUNDRED SALES PER MONTH CAN BECOME A PROFITABLE STANDALONE BUSINESS. A CATALOGUE OF COMPATIBLE PLUGINS, BUNDLES, AND EXPANSIONS SIGNIFICANTLY INCREASES LIFETIME VALUE AND REVENUE POTENTIAL.

The *Opportunity* Does *Not Require* Owning the Entire Market

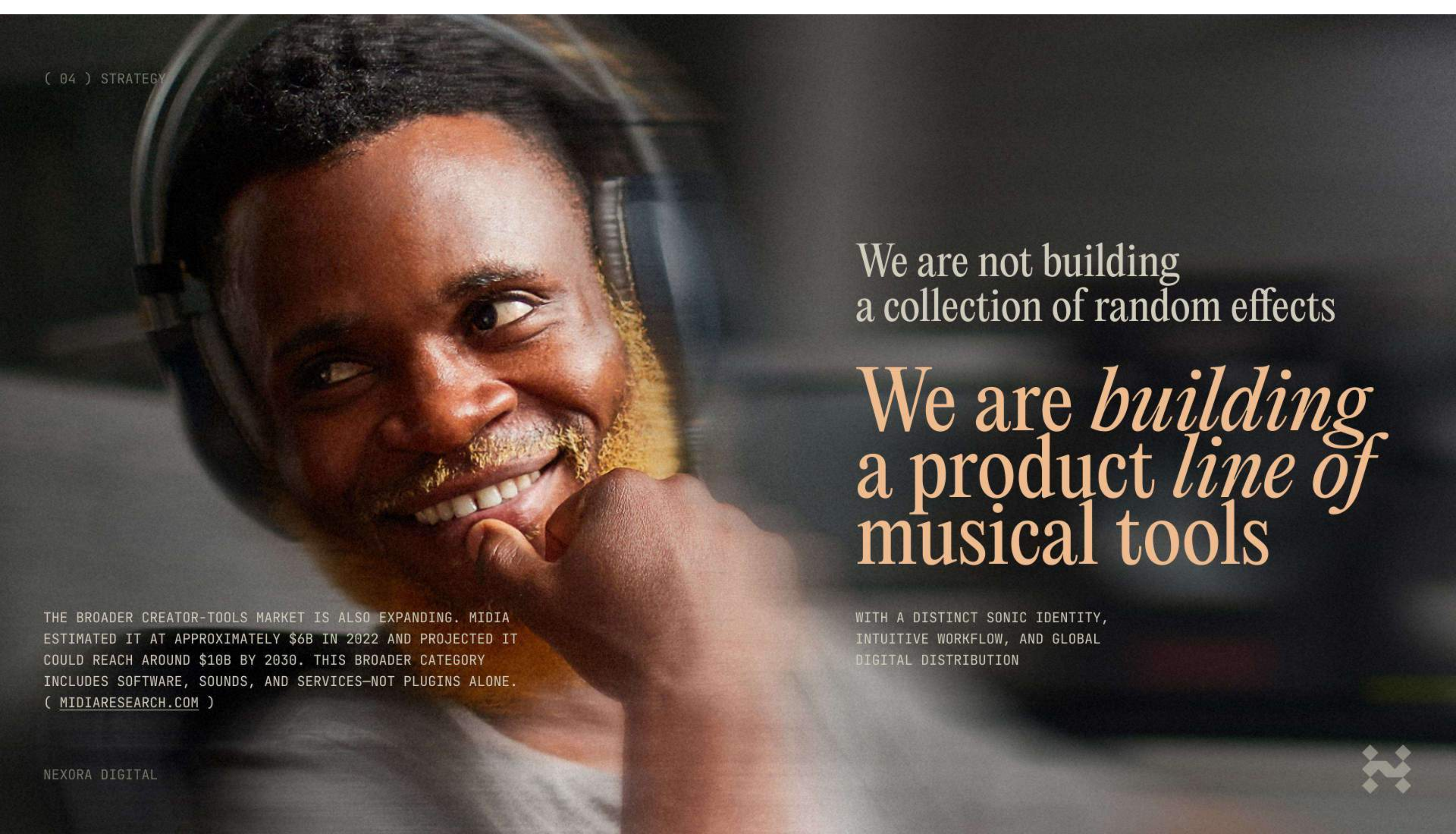
APPROXIMATE ANNUAL REVENUE:

0.01% market share ≈ $230K
0.1% market share ≈ $2.3M

With an estimated TAM of $2.3B, the goal is not to compete head-on with Waves, iZotope, or Native Instruments.

The goal is to own a recognizable micro-category:

- THE BEST TOOL FOR A SPECIFIC VOCAL STYLE
- A NEW SIGNATURE AUDIO EFFECT
- A DISTINCTIVE GENERATIVE OR AI-POWERED WORKFLOW
- A SPECIALISED INSTRUMENT FOR ELECTRONIC, CINEMATIC, POP, OR EXPERIMENTAL PRODUCTION



We are not building a collection of random effects

We are *building* a product *line of* musical tools

WITH A DISTINCT SONIC IDENTITY, INTUITIVE WORKFLOW, AND GLOBAL DIGITAL DISTRIBUTION

THE BROADER CREATOR-TOOLS MARKET IS ALSO EXPANDING. MIDIA ESTIMATED IT AT APPROXIMATELY $6B IN 2022 AND PROJECTED IT COULD REACH AROUND $10B BY 2030. THIS BROADER CATEGORY INCLUDES SOFTWARE, SOUNDS, AND SERVICES—NOT PLUGINS ALONE. (MIDIARESEARCH.COM)